

HOUSE POISED TO OK BIG CUTS

\$9-billion funding pullback would hit public broadcasting and foreign aid.

By Kevin Freking and Mary Clare Jalonick

WASHINGTON — The House is expected late Thursday to approve President Trump’s request to claw back about \$9 billion for public broadcasting and foreign aid as Republicans target institutions and programs they view as bloated or out of step with their agenda.

The White House had described the package as a test case and said that if Congress went along, more would come. The House’s approval would mark the first time in decades that a president has successfully submitted such a rescissions request to Congress, and even then the results were more mixed. Unlike other presidents, Trump is getting nearly all the cuts he requested.

Opponents voiced concerns not only about the programs targeted, but about Congress ceding its spending powers to the executive branch as investments approved on a bipartisan basis are being subsequently canceled on party-line votes. No Democrats supported the measure when it passed the Senate, 51-48, in the early morning hours Thursday. Two Republicans also voted no.

“We need to get back to [See **Spending**, A6]

Public media gird for reduced funds

NPR and PBS affiliates in Southern California decry push. **BUSINESS, A10**



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

CONSTRUCTION continues on California’s high-speed rail project along Highway 43 near Corcoran in June.

Trump pulls \$4 billion from state’s high-speed rail project

Cancellation of funds for Central Valley construction is called ‘illegal’ by Newsom.

By Colleen Shalby

The Trump administration has canceled billions of dollars in funding for California’s high-speed rail project after the state agency rejected the federal government’s assessment of the project’s failings.

The Federal Railroad Administration pulled \$4 billion in funding on Wednesday that was intended for construction in the Central Valley, according to a letter that acting FRA Administrator Drew Feeley sent to the high-speed rail project’s chief executive, Ian Choudri.

U.S. Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy has also

asked the Federal Railroad Administration to review other grants related to the project. The agency said it will consult with the Department of Justice on potentially clawing back other funds.

Gov. Gavin Newsom and Choudri questioned the legality of the administration’s decision.

“Trump wants to hand China the future and abandon the Central Valley. We won’t let him,” Newsom said in a statement Wednesday. “With projects like the Texas high-speed rail failing to take off, we are miles ahead of others. We’re now in the track-laying phase and building America’s only high-speed rail. California is putting all options on the table to fight this illegal action.”

Choudri said that the funding commitments were “legally binding agree-

ments” and that the high-speed rail authority has met its obligations.

Duffy blamed state leaders for the “mismanagement” of plans for the train.

“Governor Newsom and the complicit Democrats have enabled this waste for years. Federal dollars are not a blank check — they come with a promise to deliver results. After over a decade of failures, [the California High-Speed Rail Authority’s] mismanagement and incompetence has proven it cannot build its train to nowhere on time or on budget,” Duffy said in a statement Wednesday. “It’s time for this boondoggle to die.”

On X, Duffy said that Newsom and California “are the definition of government incompetence and possibly corruption.” In response, Newsom said he “won’t be taking advice from the guy

who can’t keep planes in the sky.”

President Trump, a vocal critic of the project who has vowed to defund it, said the decision to pull funding saves taxpayers money.

“I am thrilled to announce that I have officially freed you from funding California’s disastrously overpriced ‘high speed train to nowhere,’” Trump wrote on social media. “The railroad we were promised still does not exist, and never will. This project was severely overpriced, overregulated and never delivered.”

The high-speed rail project was supposed to be completed by 2020 but is decades off schedule and about \$100 billion over budget from its original proposal of \$33 billion. No part of the line from Los Angeles to San Francisco has been completed and construction has so far [See **Railroad**, A14]

ICE could gain access to a trove of Medicaid data

The plan to share information with immigration officials would face legal fight.

By Jenny Jarvie and Hannah Fry

The Trump administration is forging ahead with a plan that is sure to fuel alarm across California’s immigrant communities: handing over the personal data of millions of Medicaid recipients to federal immigration officials who seek to track down people living in the U.S. illegally.

The huge trove of private information, which includes home addresses, Social Security numbers and ethnicities of 79 million Medicaid

enrollees, will allow officials with Immigration and Customs Enforcement greater latitude to locate immigrants they suspect are undocumented, according to an agreement signed this week between the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services and the Department of Homeland Security and obtained by the Associated Press.

“ICE will use the CMS data to allow ICE to receive identity and location information on aliens identified by ICE,” the agreement says. The plan, which has not been announced publicly, is the latest step by the Trump administration to gather sensitive information about people living in the U.S. as it seeks to deliver on its pledge to crack down on illegal immigration and arrest 3,000

undocumented immigrants a day. It is certain to face legal challenges.

Critics have sounded the alarm ever since the Trump administration directed the CMS last month to send Homeland Security personal information on Medicaid enrollees, including non-U.S. citizens registered in state-funded programs in California, Illinois, Washington and Washington, D.C.

These states operate state-funded Medicaid programs for immigrants who are otherwise ineligible for federal Medicaid and had committed not to bill the federal government.

California Sens. Alex Padilla and Adam Schiff warned last month of potential violations of federal privacy laws as Trump officials [See **Medicaid**, A8]



SEONGJOON CHO Bloomberg

GM cars made in South Korea wait to be exported.

U.S. cars a tough sell in Asia, tariffs or no

Bigger and more expensive models may not fit consumers or their roads

By Max Kim

SEOUL — In the early 2000s, an observant driver might have noticed an unusual sight on South Korean streets: Some of the police cars were American-made Ford Tauruses.

Although South Korean patrol cars were normally supplied locally by Hyundai or Kia, the Tauruses were there as a goodwill gesture from the South Korean government, which bought 100 of them in 2002 to mollify American automakers and political leaders upset about the lopsided reality of the

automotive trade: South Korean cars sold to U.S. consumers then were subject to a 2.5% tariff rate, but American cars were hit with 8% — and faced a host of complex regulatory hurdles to boot.

As a result, in 2000, 570,000 South Korean cars were imported by the U.S., versus just 2,500 in the other direction.

Thanks to a 2012 free-trade agreement, neither country levied a tariff on the other’s cars for nearly a decade. But the one-sided flow hasn’t changed. Last year, South Korea exported 1.5 million cars to the U.S. to the [See **Cars**, A12]

Jeffrey Epstein case hounds president

By Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — The case of Jeffrey Epstein, closed long ago by investigators but nevertheless a constant source of fascination to conspiracy theorists, is the story that won’t go away for President Trump, who this week continued to resist releasing documents in the case against bipartisan calls and increasing national interest.

The case has dogged Trump’s second term from the start, ever since the attorney general, Pam Bondi, alluded to the existence of a list of Epstein’s clients sitting on her desk in February. Bondi later said she mis-



RONALDO SCHEMIDT AFP/Getty Images

PROTESTERS hold handmade signs at an anti-Trump-administration rally in Houston on Thursday.

Home prices, spirits falling

Six months after fire, many in Altadena are deciding to sell as investors buy up lots.

By Terry Castleman

As more and more Altadena residents choose to sell their fire-ravaged properties instead of rebuilding, owners are encountering a softening real estate market in which prices and the rate of sales are declining, according to data and interviews.

It’s impossible to know the long-term prospects of the market, but real estate agents and others say property sales are slowing as inventory grows and owners list their properties at lower prices.

The shift comes at a crucial moment — six months after the Eaton fire destroyed more than 6,000 homes, residents are facing the wrenching dilemma of whether to rebuild or move on.

Teresa Fuller, an agent in Altadena, described the post-fire timeline for sellers this way: “January, devastation. February, trickle. March, a few dozen went on market, and most if not all sold.”

But now, with a greater number of lots on the market and relatively few closing sales, the “absorption rate is going down, down, down,” she said. In the first week of July, 29 new lots went on the market in Altadena, she said, and only four sold.

Fuller said a couple came to her in March with a lot she estimated would get \$905,000. Now they’re ready to list, but with a far lower estimate: \$730,000. The homeowner cried when she heard the figure, saying, “This is all we have to move on,” according to Fuller.

Another lot she represents dropped from \$1.295 million to \$795,000.

Fuller provided The Times data from Altadena Multiple Listing Service lot listings since March, which totaled hundreds of listings.

The Times analyzed the data and found:

■ The ratio of active listings to properties that are pending a sale or under contract to sell has significantly increased.

■ In mid-March, there was about one active listing for every listing in the process of selling. Now, the ratio is 10 to 1.

■ Although the number of active listings has quadrupled from March to July, fewer lots are closing each week.

■ The most recent data show nearly 160 listings available, with about 10 closing per week.

This is just a snapshot of a moment, and it is possible the Altadena market will improve. Southern California has long suffered from a [See **Altadena**, A14]

UC tuition hike proposal debated

Confronted with uncertain financial outlook, regents had a tepid response and many questions. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 81/64. **B6**

Government asks for inmate lists

Justice Department seeks names of noncitizens in California jails. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

